

Our test was conducted on Windows but Inkscape is available for Linux as well.

Why Inkscape wins

- ◆ It's free.
- ◆ It's open source- New features keep getting added and It's constantly evolving. Any user that experiences a bug can report it to get universal help from the entire Inkscape community. You can even take up the challenge of patching up the bug yourself.
- ◆ It is comparable to almost all of Illustrator's features. File size- Unless you choose to save for web, Illustrator creates a lot of extra lines for the same graphics as compared to Inkscape. This gives rise to a phenomenal increase in file size.
- ◆ Inkscape is more user-friendly than Illustrator in most cases. The interface is fit for everyone from beginners to professionals.
- ◆ User support- FAQs, forums, articles and videos. There are support networks available at any given time. Illustrator's support is buried under a sea of information. When you try to contact Adobe, you are instructed to buy the phone support.
- ◆ Features that Inkscape has that Illustrator doesn't
 - ◆ Edit SVG source directly.
 - ◆ Clones, tiled clones, edit clones on canvas.
 - ◆ Keys to move/rotate/scale by screen pixels.
 - ◆ Shapes as objects.
 - ◆ Edit gradients with handles on-canvas.
 - ◆ Edit nodes with keyboard.
 - ◆ One-click paint bucket fill.
 - ◆ Color painting over objects.

Why Inkscape loses

- ◆ Illustrator will always have an edge over Inkscape purely due its commercial presence. As a graphics professional, It becomes very hard to ignore Adobe's proprietary products.
- ◆ Features that Illustrator has that Inkscape doesn't
 - ◆ Gradient meshes
 - ◆ Multiple strokes and fills for one object
 - ◆ Colour management for print
 - ◆ PMS color